

c. 1940

The following is a faithful transcription of the carbon copy of a typewritten letter by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

1940

Rev. E. F. J. Casey,
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My dear Brother, Father Edward:

God bless you and yours. I hope you are well and that the silence you maintain is only an indication that your time, like my own, flies, whither I hardly know; so that it seems almost continually blaming me for doing nothing and getting nowhere. There are so many letters, e. g. I ought to write and still so few I get off, as I would like to do personally, and as is often expected.

Thanks be to God, however, my health has been good; so that, as a rule 18 hours a day hardly seems to weigh me down at all. Again, "Deo Gratias." We've had hardly any colds in the Monastery this year and very little sickness otherwise. I just hope that we may some day learn to appreciate His graces and be grateful to God. Thanks be to God, we have good word from Father Joachim, as the enclosed copy of his letter will convince you. According to it, you will see that he is figuring on saying Holy Mass again before long. God grant it may come to that soon -- "Deo Volente."

I am not sure if I told you before of my dismay at same poor, dear Fr. M. J. 's defection, as it has seemed now close to two years, viz., since his unrest began to show itself threatening. You wrote him at the time yourself, earnest, practical lines of advice. I tried to do so too. Well, months went on before the real break came. What was in his mind, and how it was there, is not easy to say. He had been suffering for quite some time from a fearful carbuncle on the back of his neck - whether a cause or an effect of something else - enough to set many a man crazy.

At all events, while the local doctor found nothing positively wrong with his mind, there seemed to be little or nothing to be done for him or with him in the Monastery. They sent him, therefore, to the hospital in Fond du Lac, Wis., or some other, where his case was believed to be hardening of the brain-arteries or something of that nature.

Not knowing him as he ought to be, the authorities of said hospital or hospitals, seemingly made little of his case and let him go for himself. He 'phoned me from Chicago asking to speak